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Cobblebank Victoria, 3338

Student Behaviour Management Policy

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Policy is to establish the principles and expectations for student behaviour at Rosewood College, and to articulate the College's approach to behaviour management in a manner consistent with its educational philosophy and regulatory obligations.

This Policy provides the framework through which the College promotes positive student behaviour, supports the formation of character, and maintains a safe, orderly, and respectful learning environment. It affirms the College's commitment to fostering personal responsibility, self-discipline, and respect for others within a community grounded in the Catholic faith and moral tradition.

This Policy also establishes the College's commitment to procedural fairness in the management of student behaviour. It ensures that students are treated with dignity and equity, that expectations are clearly communicated, and that decisions relating to student behaviour are made in a consistent, reasonable, and transparent manner.

This Policy further provides the framework for the fair investigation and resolution of student behaviour concerns, whether raised by complaint, staff observation, parent report, student report, or otherwise brought to the attention of the School. The College recognises that behaviour concerns may vary in seriousness, context, and impact, and that responses should be proportionate, educative, and directed towards the wellbeing of students and the safety and orderly operation of the School.

This Policy is developed in accordance with the requirements of the *Education and Training Reform Regulations 2017 (Vic)*, including the minimum standards relating to student behaviour management.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- all students enrolled at Rosewood College
- all staff responsible for the care, supervision, and management of students
- all activities conducted under the authority of the College

This Policy applies to student behaviour in all contexts where a student is:

- attending the College during normal school hours
- participating in school activities, including excursions, camps, and co-curricular programs
- representing the College in any capacity
- travelling to or from the College where there is a connection to the school environment
- engaging in online or digital environments where the behaviour has a direct impact on the safety, wellbeing, or reputation of students, staff, or the College

This Policy operates in conjunction with:

- Student Behaviour Management Procedure
- Suspension and Expulsion Procedure
- Behaviour Incident Recording Procedure
- Anti-Bullying and Harassment Policy
- Anti-Bullying and Harassment Procedure
- Uniform Policy and Uniform Guidelines
- Enrolment Policy and Enrolment Agreement
- Complaints and Grievances Policy

3. Policy

3.1 Behavioural Expectations and Formation

Rosewood College establishes clear expectations for student behaviour that promote a safe, orderly, and respectful learning environment.

Student behaviour is understood as an integral part of the formation of the whole person. The College seeks to support students in the development of virtues such as responsibility, respect, self-discipline, and consideration for others, consistent with its educational philosophy grounded in the Catholic faith and moral tradition.

Students are expected to:

- act with respect towards all members of the school community
- contribute positively to the learning environment
- take responsibility for their actions and their impact on others
- comply with College rules, policies, and reasonable directions from staff

Students are also expected to understand that their behaviour may have consequences for the safety, wellbeing, and learning of others, as well as for the reputation and orderly functioning of the school community.

3.2 Positive Behaviour and Preventative Approach

The College adopts a proactive and educative approach to behaviour management, with an emphasis on:

- promoting positive behaviour

- recognising and reinforcing appropriate conduct
- supporting students to develop self-regulation and sound judgement
- addressing behaviour concerns early and constructively

The College works in partnership with parents and guardians to support consistent expectations and the development of positive student behaviour.

3.3 Behaviour Management Principles

In responding to student behaviour concerns, the College:

- treats all concerns seriously and appropriately, having regard to their nature, context, and impact
- recognises that behaviour concerns may range from minor to very serious, and that responses should be proportionate to the circumstances
- investigates and respond to concerns where appropriate, whether or not a formal complaint has been made
- acts as promptly as reasonably practicable
- applies the principles of procedural fairness
- maintains confidentiality to the extent reasonably possible, having regard to the need to investigate and resolve the matter properly, protect safety and wellbeing, and comply with legal obligations
- has regard to the age, maturity, individual circumstances, and wellbeing of the student
- seeks, where appropriate, to combine disciplinary responses with educative, pastoral, and restorative measures

3.4 Prohibition of Corporal Punishment

Rosewood College does not permit or sanction corporal punishment of students in any circumstances.

Corporal punishment must not be administered by any staff member, volunteer, contractor, parent, guardian, or any other person for the purpose of enforcing discipline, or any other reason, at the College.

This prohibition applies to all behaviour management practices and operates in conjunction with this Policy, the Student Behaviour Management Procedure, and related student safety and wellbeing policies.

3.5 Fair and Consistent Management of Behaviour

Student behaviour is managed in a manner that is:

- fair and proportionate
- consistent across the College
- responsive to the age, maturity, and individual circumstances of the student
- directed towards the development and wellbeing of the student
- mindful of the rights, safety, and wellbeing of other students, staff, and members of the school community

The College recognises that behaviour concerns may vary significantly in seriousness, context, frequency, and impact. Accordingly, the process followed and any response or consequence imposed may differ depending on the nature of the behaviour, the surrounding circumstances, any prior concerns, the needs of those affected, and the need to protect the safety, wellbeing, and orderly operation of the College.

The College may implement appropriate consequences where behaviour does not meet expectations. Such consequences are determined having regard to the nature, seriousness, and context of the behaviour, and may be accompanied by supportive or restorative measures where appropriate.

3.6 Procedural Fairness

Rosewood College is committed to the principles of procedural fairness in all matters relating to student behaviour.

This includes ensuring that:

- students are aware of behavioural expectations and relevant policies
- allegations of, or concerns about inappropriate behaviour are communicated clearly, where appropriate having regard to the age of the student and the circumstances of the matter
- students are given a reasonable opportunity to respond to concerns raised
- decisions are made by an appropriately authorised person
- decisions are based on relevant information and made in a reasonable and transparent manner
- significant behaviour matters are handled in a manner that is fair, timely, and proportionate

Procedural fairness applies to all behaviour management processes, including those that may result in significant disciplinary action.

Where a student is required to attend a formal meeting in relation to a significant behaviour concern or possible disciplinary action, the student may be accompanied by a parent, guardian, or other support person, subject to the College's reasonable requirements for the proper conduct of the meeting. A support person is present to provide support and does not ordinarily act as an advocate unless the College permits otherwise.

3.7 Investigation and Response

Where concerns arise regarding student behaviour, the College may make such inquiries as it considers appropriate in the circumstances. This may include gathering relevant information, speaking with staff and students involved, obtaining written accounts, reviewing available records or other relevant material, and meeting with the student concerned.

The College may investigate and respond to alleged inappropriate behaviour whether the matter is raised by formal complaint, informal report, staff observation, or otherwise comes to the attention of the College.

The nature and extent of any investigation, and the process followed, depends on the seriousness and circumstances of the matter, including any issues of confidentiality, safety, wellbeing, and the number of students involved.

Where appropriate, the student is informed of the substance of the concern and given an opportunity to respond before a decision is made.

Nothing in this Policy prevents the College from taking immediate action where reasonably necessary to protect the safety, wellbeing, or orderly operation of the College pending further inquiry or determination.

Where alleged behaviour may involve unlawful conduct or present a serious risk to health, safety, or wellbeing, the College may refer the matter to external authorities or seek external advice, as appropriate.

3.8 Disciplinary Action

The College may take disciplinary action where a student's behaviour does not meet expected standards.

Disciplinary action may include a range of responses appropriate to the circumstances, including, where necessary:

- counselling, guidance, or restorative action
- removal from class or temporary withdrawal from a particular setting or activity (e.g., lunchtime/after-school detention)
- internal or external suspension
- expulsion from the College

All disciplinary actions are undertaken in accordance with this Policy and the relevant procedures, including the Suspension and Expulsion Procedure.

Where appropriate, disciplinary responses may be accompanied by pastoral, wellbeing, behavioural support, or restorative measures aimed at assisting the student to reflect, repair harm, and re-engage positively with the life of the College.

The Principal may take immediate interim action, including removal from class, withdrawal from an activity, or suspension in accordance with the relevant procedure, where this is reasonably necessary to protect the safety, wellbeing, or orderly operation of the College pending further inquiry.

3.9 Roles and Responsibilities

The Principal is responsible for ensuring that student behaviour is managed in accordance with this Policy and that appropriate procedures are in place and implemented consistently.

The Principal, or an appropriately authorised delegate, is responsible for:

- overseeing significant behaviour matters and disciplinary processes
- ensuring that investigations and decisions are conducted fairly and in accordance with this Policy
- determining appropriate responses in serious matters, including suspension or recommendation of expulsion where applicable under the relevant procedure
- ensuring that proper records are maintained

Staff are responsible for:

- promoting and modelling expected standards of behaviour
- supporting students in meeting behavioural expectations
- applying this Policy and associated procedures consistently and fairly

Staff are also responsible for:

- responding to behaviour concerns in a timely, proportionate, and appropriate manner

- reporting significant or repeated behaviour concerns, or behaviour that may give rise to serious disciplinary action, in accordance with College procedures
- maintaining appropriate records in accordance with College procedures

Parent(s)/Guardian(s) are expected to:

- support the College's behavioural expectations
- work in partnership with the College to address behaviour concerns

Parent(s)/Guardian(s) are also expected to participate, where appropriate, in meetings or processes relating to significant behaviour matters involving their child.

Students are responsible for:

- meeting the behavioural expectations of the College
- responding positively to guidance and direction from staff

Students are also responsible for participating honestly and respectfully in behaviour management processes.

3.10 Relationship to Other Policies and Procedures

This Policy is supported by, and should be read in conjunction with, the College's behaviour management procedures and related policies, including those addressing:

- behaviour management processes
- suspension and expulsion
- bullying and harassment
- student safety and wellbeing

These documents provide the operational detail for the implementation of this Policy.

4. Implementation

The Principal is responsible for the implementation of this Policy and for ensuring that student behaviour is managed in a manner consistent with the College's educational philosophy, this Policy, and applicable regulatory requirements.

The Principal ensures that:

- appropriate procedures are established and maintained to support the implementation of this Policy, including:
    - Student Behaviour Management Procedure
    - Suspension and Expulsion Procedure
    - Behaviour Incident Recording Procedure
- expectations of student behaviour are clearly communicated to students, staff, and parent(s)/guardian(s)
- staff are supported and trained to apply behaviour management practices consistently and in accordance with this Policy
- systems are in place for the recording, monitoring, and review of student behaviour, including behavioural incidents, investigations, supports implemented, suspensions, and expulsions

- behaviour management practices are regularly monitored to ensure consistency, fairness, and alignment with the College's values

Staff are responsible for:

- implementing this Policy and associated procedures in their day-to-day interactions with students
- modelling appropriate behaviour and reinforcing College expectations
- responding to behaviour concerns in a timely, consistent, and proportionate manner
- maintaining appropriate records in accordance with College procedures

Staff must also treat behaviour matters confidentially, except to the extent disclosure is necessary to investigate and resolve the matter properly, support student wellbeing, or meet legal obligations.

The College maintains appropriate records of student behaviour incidents, investigations, meetings, supports implemented, disciplinary decisions, and outcomes as evidence of the consistent application of this Policy and to support ongoing monitoring and review. Where relevant, records are retained on the student's file in accordance with College procedures and applicable privacy obligations.

The Governing Authority provides oversight of the College's compliance with the minimum standards for school registration, including the effective implementation of this Policy.

4.1 Communication to the School Community

The College communicates student behaviour management expectations, policies, and procedures to the school community through appropriate channels, which may include:

- enrolment materials, including the Enrolment Agreement
- the Parent Handbook
- student orientation and ongoing student reminders
- staff induction, staff meetings, and professional learning
- direct communication with parent(s)/guardian(s) where behaviour concerns arise
- publication or access through the College's approved document management or communication systems

The Principal is responsible for ensuring that student behaviour management policies and procedures are accessible to staff, students, and parent(s)/guardian(s), and that key expectations are communicated in a clear and age-appropriate manner.

5. Review

This Policy will be reviewed at least every two years, or earlier if required due to:

- changes to legislation or regulatory requirements, including the *Education and Training Reform Regulations 2017 (Vic)*
- changes to College operations or behaviour management practices
- identified issues arising from the implementation or monitoring of this Policy
- direction from the Governing Authority

The Principal is responsible for initiating the review of this Policy.

The Governing Authority is responsible for the approval of any amendments.

6. Related Documents

Related documents include:

- Restrictive Interventions Policy
- Student Behaviour Management Procedure
- Student Code of Conduct Policy
- Suspension and Expulsion Procedure